

THE MOVE

Reduce the effort: "If it's easy, could you send the link?" -> **Reduce the ambiguity:** "A yes or no is all I need." -> **Give an easy path to reply:** "A one-line answer is plenty." -> **Make no genuinely acceptable:** "No worries at all if not."

START HERE

Add one small easing clause to your request — "if it's easy" or "no worries if not" — that makes a genuine no just as available as a yes.

SAY THIS

Quick openers	<i>"If it's easy, could you send the link? No worries if not."</i>
Warm & optional	<i>"No worries at all if you'd rather not."</i>
Work & professional	<i>"If you have 30 seconds, could you point me to the right person?"</i>
The clean ask	<i>"Could you send me the link when you get a moment?"</i>
Digital / text	<i>"To make sure I'm chasing the right thing — is it the March version you need?"</i>
When it lands heavy	<i>"Sorry — that came out more urgent than I meant. Genuinely no rush."</i>

AVOID

- The ask has real stakes that need a full, honest discussion.
- Saying no would be socially risky for them.
- The other person has less power, so "optional" may not feel optional.

REMEMBER

Easier to answer, not harder to refuse.